

Aaron Chuey, Ph.D.

✉ aaronchuey@fas.harvard.edu

🔗 Google Scholar

📍 Harvard University, Department of Psychology, 33 Kirkland St., Cambridge, MA, 02138

Education & Employment

- 2025 – present 📌 **Postdoctoral Scholar, Psychology, Harvard University**
PI: Ashley Thomas
- 2019 – 2025 📌 **Ph.D., Psychology, Stanford University**
Thesis title: *Theory of Minds: early understanding of interacting minds.*
Advisor: Hyowon Gweon
- 2016 – 2019 📌 **Lab Manager, Yale University.**
PI: Frank Keil.
- 2013 – 2016 📌 **B.A., Philosophy & Cognitive Science, University of Michigan**
With Highest Distinction.

Honors & Awards

- 2019–2024 📌 **Stinehart-Reed Graduate Fellowship.** *Stanford University*
- 2024 📌 **Travel Grant Award.** *Cognitive Science Society*
- 2023 📌 **Travel Grant Award.** *Cognitive Science Society*
- 2022 📌 **Norman Anderson Research Grant.** *Stanford University*
- 2016 📌 **Frankena Prize.** *University of Michigan, Department of Philosophy*
- 2014–2016 📌 **Angell Scholar.** *University of Michigan*
- 2013 📌 **Branstrom Prize.** *University of Michigan*
- 📌 **Regents Merit Scholarship.** *University of Michigan*

Research Publications

Manuscripts in Progress

- 1 **Chuey, Aaron**, Hyowon Gweon, and Ashley Thomas (in prep). *Preschoolers accurately represent the structure of their class' social network.*
- 2 **Chuey, Aaron**, Robert Z. Sparks, and Hyowon Gweon (in revision @ Cognition). *Young children's understanding of communication as causal influence.* 🔗 URL: https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/hvm7r_v1.

Journal Articles

- 1 **Chuey, Aaron**, Julian Jara-Ettinger, and Hyowon Gweon (2026). "Young children understand how social connections affect what people know about each other". In: *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 123.12, e2525150123. 🔗 URL: <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2525150123>.
- 2 **Chuey, Aaron**, Rondeline M Williams, Catherine Qing, et al. (2026). "Children's understanding of how noise disrupts verbal communication". In: *Child Development*, pp. 1–11.
- 3 **Chuey, Aaron** and Hyowon Gweon (2025). "Theory of Minds: early understanding of interacting minds". In: *Annual Review of Developmental Psychology* 7, pp. 1–27.
- 4 **Chuey, Aaron**, Veronica Boyce, et al. (2024). "Conducting developmental research online vs. in-person: A meta-analysis". In: *Open Mind* 8, pp. 795–808.

- 5 **Chuey, Aaron**, Yiwei Luo, and Ellen M Markman (2024). "Epistemic language in news headlines shapes readers' perceptions of objectivity". In: *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 121.20, e2314091121.
- 6 **Chuey, Aaron**, Kristi Lockhart, Emmanuel Trouche, et al. (2023). "Young children can infer information preferences from goals and recommend appropriate sources to others." In: *Developmental Psychology* 59.8, p. 1511.
- 7 Asaba, Mika, **Aaron Chuey**, and Hyowon Gweon (2021). "Beyond knowledge versus belief: The contents of mental-state representations and their underlying computations". In: *Behavioral and Brain Sciences* 44.
- 8 **Chuey, Aaron**, Mika Asaba, et al. (2021). "Moderated online data-collection for developmental research: Methods and replications". In: *Frontiers in psychology* 12, p. 734398.
- 9 **Chuey, Aaron**, Amanda McCarthy, et al. (2021). "No guts, no glory: underestimating the benefits of providing children with mechanistic details". In: *npj Science of Learning* 6.1, p. 30.
- 10 **Chuey, Aaron**, Kristi Lockhart, Mark Sheskin, et al. (2020). "Children and adults selectively generalize mechanistic knowledge". In: *Cognition* 199, p. 104231.
- 11 Lockhart, Kristi L et al. (2019). "The privileged status of knowing mechanistic information: An early epistemic bias". In: *Child development* 90.5, pp. 1772–1788.

Conference Proceedings

- 1 **Chuey, Aaron**, Hyowon Gweon, and Ashley Thomas (2026). "Early-emerging representation of social networks". In: *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. Vol. 48.
- 2 **Chuey, Aaron**, Catherine Qing, et al. (2024). "Show or Tell? Preschool-aged children adapt their communication to their partner's auditory access". In: *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. Vol. 46.
- 3 **Chuey, Aaron**, Julian Jara-Ettinger, and Hyowon Gweon (2023). "Violation of epistemic expectations: Children monitor what others know and recognize unexpected sources of knowledge". In: *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. Vol. 45. 45.
- 4 **Chuey, Aaron**, Yiwei Luo, and Ellen M Markman (2023). "Epistemic language in news headlines affects readers' perceptions of objectivity". In: *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. Vol. 45. 45.
- 5 **Chuey, Aaron**, Robert Sparks, and Hyowon Gweon (2023). "Young children can identify knowledgeable speakers from their causal influence over listeners". In: *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. Vol. 45.
- 6 **Chuey, Aaron**, Rondeline M Williams, Michael C Frank, et al. (2022). "Young children's reasoning about the epistemic consequences of auditory noise". In: *Proceedings of the annual meeting of the cognitive science society*. Vol. 44. 44.
- 7 **Chuey, Aaron**, Mark Sheskin, and Frank Keil (2018). "Mechanistic Knowledge Generalizes Differentially". In: *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. Vol. 40.
- 8 Trouche, Emmanuel, **Aaron Chuey**, Kristi Lockhart, et al. (2018). "Children Don't Just Wanna Have Fun: An Experimental Demonstration Of Children's Curiosity For How Things Work." In: *CogSci*.
- 9 Trouche, Emmanuel, **Aaron Chuey**, Kristi L Lockhart, et al. (2017). "Why teach how things work? Tracking the evolution of children's intuitions about complexity". In: *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*. Vol. 39.

Presentations

Invited Talks

- 2026  **UCSD, Schachner Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **Duke, Amir Lab Meeting**, *Social Network Cognition*.
- 2025  **MIT, Schulz Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **Harvard, Labs for Developmental Studies Meeting**, *Social Network Cognition*.
- 2024  **Harvard, Thomas Lab Meeting**, *Social Network Cognition*.
-  **Harvard, Labs for Developmental Studies Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **UCSB, Liberman Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **Harvard, Thomas Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
- 2023  **MIT, Saxe Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **Stanford, Psychology Department Colloquium**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **UCSD, Fan Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **UCB, Srinivasan Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **UCB, Engelmann Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **UCSC, Developmental Colloquium**, *Theory of Minds*.
- 2022  **Yale, Jara-Ettinger Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **Stanford, Gerstenberg Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
-  **UCB, Gopnik Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.
- 2020  **Yale, Jara-Ettinger Lab Meeting**, *Theory of Minds*.

Guest Lectures

- 2025  **UCSD, Methods in Infancy Cognition Guest Lecture**, *Online Devo Methods*.
- 2024  **Stanford, Symbolic Systems**, *Theory of Minds*.
- 2020  **Virtual Webinar**, *Online Devo Methods*.

Conference Presentations

- 2026  **Montreal, CDS**, *Poster*.
- 2024  **Rotterdam, Cogsci**, *Talk*.
-  **Pasadena, CDS**, *Symposium talk, co-organized with Brandon Woo*.
- 2023  **Sydney, Cogsci**, *Talk*.
-  **Sydney, Cogsci**, *Poster*.
-  **Sydney, Cogsci**, *Poster*.
- 2022  **Gottingen, Social Curiosity Workshop**, *Talk*.
-  **Toronto, Cogsci**, *Talk*.
-  **Madison, CDS**, *Preconference talk*.
-  **Madison, CDS**, *Poster*.
- 2021  **Virtual, Cogsci**, *Poster*.
- 2018  **Madison, Cogsci**, *Talk*.
-  **Madison, Cogsci**, *Poster*.
- 2017  **London, Cogsci**, *Poster*.

Ad-hoc reviewing

- Journals  Cognition, Cognitive Development, Cognitive Psychology, Cognitive Science, Frontiers in Communication, Developmental Science, Frontiers in Education, Infant and Child Development, Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, Open Mind, Pragmatics and Cognition, Scientific Reports
- Conferences  Cognitive Science Society

Professional Memberships

- 2017 – present  Cognitive Science Society
- 2022 – present  Cognitive Development Society

Mentorship

- Masters Thesis students  **Catherine Qing**, Stanford Symbolic Systems (co-advised with Hyo Gweon)
Thesis title: *Show or Tell? Preschool-aged children adapt their communication to their partner's auditory access*
- Senior Thesis students  **Bobby Sparks**, Stanford Symbolic Systems (co-advised with Hyo Gweon)
Thesis title: *Preschool-Aged Children Can Infer What Speakers Know Based on How They Influence Others*
Audrey King, Harvard Psychology (co-advised with Ashley Thomas)
Thesis title: *How Children Reason About Communication Across Language Barriers* (awarded the Psychology Faculty Prize)

Technical Skills

- Coding  Python, R, Javascript (jspsych), WebPPL, $\text{\LaTeX}$,
- Survey tools  Qualtrics, Lookit
- Misc.  Video editing (iMovie), Image editing (Paint Pro), Audio editing (Audacity)